

Introduction

This Fast Track to Android gets you started with your latest Android phone right from the basics to advanced tinkering. Chapter 1 serves as an introduction to the Android platform and why you should buy an Android phone – if you haven’t yet!

Next, we go on to explain how to accomplish the most basic things on your Android phone, from making phone calls and sending texts, to managing your contacts, alarms, reminders and setting up your calendar. Chapter 4 goes on to explain how to use the Settings application to configure how your phone looks, sounds, communicates, protects your privacy, and operates in many other ways.

Now that you are pretty versed in the basics of Android, we will show you how to productively use the Photos and Videos applications to take stunning shots, view galleries and watch videos on your shiny new 4.3-inch screen. We will even show you how to use your phone to navigate using GPS, how to stay connected with friends on the go with the Chat application and how to find anything on the internet with Android’s Search function in chapter 6.

Chapters 7 and 8 will introduce you the amazing world on Android apps, where you can find third-party apps to do almost everything a phone is capable of, from telling you what song is playing when you hold up the phone, how much that book you’re holding costs at a number of web sites and local stores, or even adjust your phone’s ringtone or volume based on where you are. The chapter 9 on tips and tricks will help you use your phone even more productively.

Finally, chapter 10 chapter covers a few of the basic problems you might encounter and helps you take some steps to fix them. Your phone is a complicated piece of equipment. Sure, it’s small, and it appears relatively simple on the outside, but a lot of little things can go wrong. We don’t want to scare you, though. Most of the problems you will encounter are pretty simple to resolve using the instructions in this chapter. 